

Child Care Outbreak Checklist

Manage an outbreak

All staff share responsibility to keep children safe. This checklist provides general measures for staff to complete during an outbreak.

- Follow all recommendations made by the AHS Public Health Outbreak team.
- Refer to the [Guide for Outbreak Prevention & Control in Child Care Facilities](#) for more detailed recommendations and follow facility-specific policies.

Communicate about the outbreak

- ☐ Inform parents/guardians, staff and visitors of the outbreak.
- ☐ Report children and staff who are newly symptomatic daily to the AHS Public Health Outbreak team.

Use infection prevention control measures

- ☐ Encourage children and staff to practice frequent hand hygiene and respiratory etiquette.
- ☐ Provide easy access to hand washing stations.

Keep the facility illness free

- ☐ Remind parents/guardians to keep children who are ill home.
- ☐ Send staff who are ill home.
- ☐ Keep children away from others if they are ill at the facility and contact parents/guardians to pick them up as soon as possible.

Care for children who develop viral respiratory illness

- ☐ Offer a mask to children over two years of age if tolerated.
- ☐ Have staff wear a mask when caring for a child who is ill.

Care for children who develop GI illness

- ☐ Dedicate a washroom for children who are ill.
- ☐ Have staff wear gloves and gown/protective clothing while caring for a child who is ill.

Enhance cleaning and disinfection

- ☐ Increase the frequency of cleaning and disinfection of common areas and high touch surfaces such as doorknobs and washrooms.
- ☐ Clean and disinfect shared items between users.
- ☐ Remove shared items such as craft supplies, books and puzzles that cannot be cleaned and disinfected.
- ☐ Increase the frequency of cleaning and disinfection of shared transport vehicles.

Decrease the use of common or shared items

- ☐ Use shared play structures one group at a time.
- ☐ Close shared sensory tables including water/sand tables.

Modify activities and food services

- ☐ Keep children and staff within their assigned child care room, including during naps, meals and snack times.
- ☐ Postpone high-risk field trips and activities.
- ☐ Cease family-style meal service.
- ☐ Hand out snacks directly to children.